Living Ink

Company Overview Living Ink is a Colorado-based biomaterials company that creates sustainable ink for printing and packaging. They have worked with major brands like Nike and Patagonia to replace traditional, toxic black pigments with a carbon-negative alternative made from algae.

ESG Focus: Algae-Derived Pigments (Carbon-Negative Ink)



Why (The Problem) Most black ink used in the world is made from "Carbon Black," which is a pigment derived from heavy petroleum (oil). Producing this ink releases high levels of CO_2 and involves hazardous chemicals that are bad for both the workers and the environment.

How (The Solution) Living Ink uses waste algae cells (the leftovers from the algae oil industry) to create a bio-based black pigment. Algae naturally absorbs CO_2 as it grows. By turning this algae into ink, the company "locks" the carbon into a solid form, preventing it from entering the atmosphere.

What (The Outcome) This creates "Algae Ink," the first high-performance, black pigment that is carbon-negative. It works just like traditional ink for screen printing on clothes or packaging boxes, but it is biodegradable and much safer for the planet.

Impact: For every ton of Algae Ink used, the environment is spared from the heavy pollution of traditional oil-based pigments. It turns the printing industry into a tool for carbon sequestration.